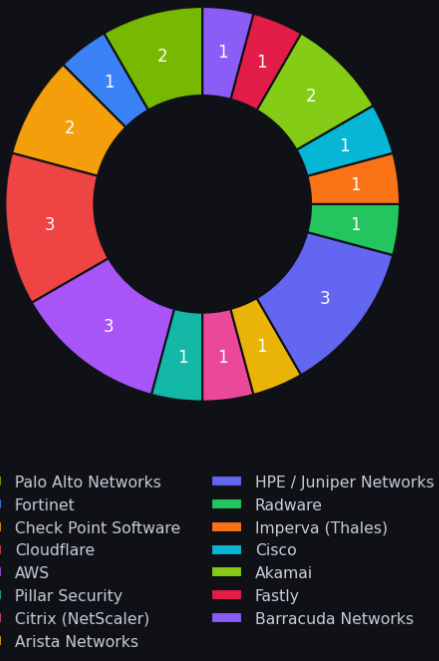
F5 Daily Briefing – Monday, October 19, 2026

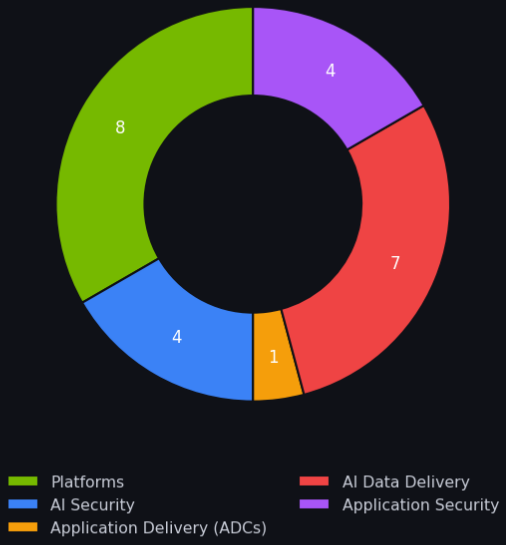
Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22	24	15	5
COMPETITORS TRACKED	ANNOUNCEMENTS	ACTIVE	ACTIVE CATEGORIES

Announcements by Competitor



Announcements by Category



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (24)

Product Launch **Palo Alto Networks** Platforms 2026-10-19

Palo Alto Networks Launches Cortex XDR One, Merging XDR and Agentic Endpoint Security

Palo Alto Networks announced Cortex XDR One, combining Cortex XDR and Cortex Agentic Endpoint Security in one sensor and one console. It keeps a real-time inventory of AI agents and shadow AI on endpoints, adds runtime guardrails against prompt injection and destructive commands, and runs local ML that works offline, feeding Cortex XSIAM for AI-risk governance. This extends Palo Alto's single-platform AI security pitch; F5 should position AI Guardrails as a vendor-neutral, network-layer control.

Source: https://www.paloaltonetworks.com/blog/2026/10/reinventing-endpoint-security-with-cortex-xdr-one/

Product Launch | Fortinet | Platforms | 2026-10-19

Fortinet Opens FortiSASE Point-of-Presence in Oman

Fortinet opened a dedicated FortiSASE Point-of-Presence in Oman, announced at Fortinet Security Day in Muscat. The local POP processes traffic in-country to cut latency and support data sovereignty and regulatory compliance, while giving hybrid and remote workers zero-trust access to web, cloud and private apps. Fortinet is using sovereign local infrastructure to win in the Middle East, a buying factor F5 field teams in the region should expect to hear.

Source: https://theuaedaily.com/2026/10/19/fortinet-strengthens-its-commitment-to-oman-by-opening-fortisase-point-of-presence/

Research | Check Point Software | Platforms | 2026-10-19

Check Point Research Q3 2026 Brand Phishing Report: Microsoft Impersonated in 33% of Attacks

Check Point Research's Q3 2026 Brand Phishing Report found Microsoft in 33% of brand impersonation attempts, up from 23% in Q2, with Apple and Google at 8% each. Attackers are shifting to AI and developer-tool lures, such as fake Claude billing alerts and lookalike Google Antigravity sites that trick users into running malicious terminal commands. The report backs Check Point's prevention-first message and gives F5 marketing and field teams a current stat on AI-themed attacks.

Source: https://cxotoday.com/cybersecurity/check-point-q3-2026-audit-microsoft-impersonated-in-33-of-global-brand-phishing-attacks/

Partnership | Cloudflare | Platforms | 2026-10-19

Cloudflare AI Workspace Platform (Cloudflare OS) Adds Application and Deployment Partners

Cloudflare added Asana, Box, Canva, ClickHouse, GitHub, Gong, Notion and others as partners for Cloudflare OS, its enterprise AI workspace, with EPAM, Happy Cog and Towards AI deploying it and training customer teams. Cloudflare OS runs on Cloudflare's network with Zero Trust access for agents, while AI Gateway routes across models to control token costs. This reinforces Cloudflare's single-platform AI pitch, competing with F5's Application Delivery and Security Platform and AI Gateway story.

Source: https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20261019839947/en/Cloudflares-AI-Workspace-Platform-Partners-with-Leading-Applications-and-Deployment-Teams-to-Make-AI-Productive-in-the-Enterprise

Product Launch | Cloudflare | Platforms | 2026-10-19

Cloudflare Cloud Workload Security Now Available in Beta

Cloudflare released Cloud Workload Security in beta. It checks cloud API requests against policies before they reach the provider, using request filters and Rego rules, for example blocking an R2 bucket from being made public. Policies are managed in the Cloudflare dashboard and enforced by a customer-run proxy; a Zero Trust subscription is required, and the free plan qualifies. This pushes Cloudflare One into cloud control-plane security, widening its overlap with F5 multicloud security.

Source: https://developers.cloudflare.com/changelog/post/2026-10-19-cloud-workload-security-beta/

Product Launch | AWS | Platforms | 2026-10-19

Amazon GuardDuty Adds 50+ Optional Runtime Monitoring Detection Rules

Amazon GuardDuty added more than 50 optional Runtime Monitoring detection rules for EC2, EKS and ECS (EC2 and Fargate), watching process, file and network activity mapped to MITRE ATT&CK. It adds four finding types, including Exfiltration:Runtime/SuspiciousCommand, plus a dry-run mode for testing rules, in all commercial Regions and GovCloud (US). AWS keeps expanding native workload security, which F5 must account for when positioning alongside AWS built-in controls.

Source: https://www.daily-aws.com/headlines/20261019/

Research | Pillar Security | AI Security | 2026-10-19

Pillar Security Discloses Remote Code Execution Flaw in opencode via MCP OAuth

Pillar Security found a remote code execution flaw in the opencode AI coding agent on Windows and WSL: in versions up to 1.18.32, a malicious remote MCP server could run PowerShell commands during the MCP OAuth discovery handshake, with no prompt injection or extra consent needed. The fix is in opencode 1.18.33. This adds to Pillar's agent and MCP threat research, competing with F5 AI Red Team, and shows guardrails must cover MCP and agent toolchains, not just prompts.

Source: https://www.pillar.security/blog/open-and-shut-remote-code-execution-in-opencode-via-mcp-oauth

Research | Citrix (NetScaler) | Application Delivery (ADCs) | 2026-10-19

Rapid7 Details NetScaler Intrusions Chaining CVE-2026-88779 and CVE-2026-88771

Rapid7 described a NetScaler ADC compromise in which attackers chained CVE-2026-88779 and CVE-2026-88771 to run code as root, deployed PHP web shells behind disguised Apache aliases, and persisted via cron jobs, rc.netscaler and watchdog changes. The same day, Cloudflare urged NetScaler gateway operators to put independent access controls in front of authentication. Ongoing NetScaler exploitation opens ADC displacement and security-posture conversations for F5.

Source: https://www.rapid7.com/blog/post/ra-netscaler-intrusions-chaining-cve-2026-88771-and-cve-2026-88779/

Financial | Arista Networks | AI Data Delivery | 2026-10-19

Arista Shares Rise About 3.8% Ahead of Q3 Earnings on AI Networking Demand

Arista Networks stock rose 3.3-3.8% to about $183.70, a market value of roughly $231B, on a technical rebound, institutional buying and AI data center switching demand ahead of Q3 results on November 3. Coverage flagged high valuation, insider sales and rising component costs as risks. Investors still see Arista's AI fabric business as strong, keeping pressure on F5's AI networking and data delivery positioning.

Source: https://www.tradingkey.com/news/market-movers/262224050-market-movers-anet-20261019

Executive | HPE / Juniper Networks | AI Data Delivery | 2026-10-19

HPE Networking Chief Links $1.2B Vultr Neocloud Deal to AI Networking Revenue Synergies

SDxCentral reported HPE Networking CEO Rami Rahim tied a $1.2B Vultr deal for AMD Helios-based AI racks to a networking revenue-synergy opportunity. The deal covers Vultr's U.S. data centers for AI training and inference, draws on Juniper hardware and Broadcom Tomahawk 6, and is positioned as HPE's entry into neoclouds and sovereign clouds. HPE is pushing into AI data center fabrics where F5 targets AI traffic management and delivery.

Source: https://www.sdxcentral.com/news/hpe-networking-chief-links-12b-vultr-neocloud-win-to-revenue-synergy-opportunity/

Event | HPE / Juniper Networks | AI Data Delivery | 2026-10-19

HPE and Juniper Run a Multi-Path Traffic Engineering Workshop at NANOG 98

HPE and Juniper sponsored a hands-on Multi-Path Traffic Engineering workshop at NANOG 98, limited to 50 attendees, using virtual vMX and cRPD routers to configure MPTE and examine RSVP/BGP signaling in WAN and AI data center interconnect environments. It was led by HPE's Vishnu Pavan Kumar Beeram and Jeffrey Zhang and Juniper's Kireeti Kompella. HPE/Juniper is building operator mindshare in AI data center traffic engineering.

Source: https://nanog.org/events/n98-hpe-workshop/

Financial | Radware | Application Security | 2026-10-19

Radware Stock Rises 5.12% in Monday Session

Radware shares rose 5.12% to close at $28.55, up from $27.16, with same-day Simply Wall St analysis linking investor attention to its recent MCP Server Protection launch for agentic AI. The move suggests the market is rewarding application security vendors that extend into agentic AI security, a narrative F5 can counter with its AI Guardrails and AI Red Team portfolio.

Source: https://www.globalbankingandfinance.com/radware-rdwr-rises-2026-10-19/

Research | Imperva (Thales) | Application Security | 2026-10-19

Imperva Threat Intelligence Report: October 19, 2026

Imperva's weekly threat intelligence report highlights attackers abusing trusted ecosystems through compromised cloud integrations, malicious packages and third-party providers; rising identity-based attacks via large-scale phishing and fraudulent IT-worker schemes; supply-chain risk spreading to hardware and networking gear; and attacks on shared infrastructure disrupting retailers and government services. Thales uses this research as proof points for its app and API security narrative that F5 competes against.

Source: https://imperva.substack.com/p/threat-intelligence-october-19-2026

Product Launch | Palo Alto Networks | AI Security | 2026-10-19

Unit 42 Managed Agentic Endpoint Security Adds 24/7 Expert Defense for AI Agents

Palo Alto Networks introduced Unit 42 Managed Agentic Endpoint Security, a managed service built on Cortex AES. Unit 42 experts provide AI-adoption governance, hunting for AI-related threats including zero-days, 24/7 investigation and response, and ongoing AI security hygiene reporting. It is sold with standalone Cortex AES or with Cortex XDR One. Palo Alto is wrapping managed services around its AI security offer, raising the bar for F5 AI Guardrails and AI Red Team service and partner motions.

Source: https://www.paloaltonetworks.com/blog/2026/10/introducing-unit-42-managed-agentic-endpoint-security/

Partnership | Cisco | AI Data Delivery | 2026-10-19

Hotwire Communications Validates Cisco 8223 (Silicon One P200) at 51.2Tbps over Live Fiber

Hotwire Communications carried 800GE over live production fiber in South Florida using Cisco 8223 routers, built on Silicon One P200 at 51.2 Tbps, with Cisco 800G ZR+ coherent optics. The test shows higher capacity in a small footprint without replacing existing equipment. It is a customer proof point for Cisco's AI-era networking hardware and supports Cisco's case for owning the transport beneath AI traffic delivery.

Source: https://hotwirecommunications.com/in-the-news/hotwire-communications-validates-51-2tbps-cisco-8223-and-800g-zr-coherent-optics-over-live-production-fiber

Partnership | Check Point Software | AI Security | 2026-10-19

Check Point Expands Multi-Year Strategic Collaboration Agreement with AWS for AI and Cloud Security

Check Point and AWS expanded their 2024 Strategic Collaboration Agreement into a new multi-year deal. It puts Check Point's Lakera-powered AI Defense Plane on AWS Marketplace and integrates AI security with Amazon Bedrock and Bedrock AgentCore, with AWS co-sell programs easing purchase and deployment. This competes directly with F5 for AWS AI security deals and marketplace attention, which matters to F5 cloud alliances and AWS co-sell teams.

Source: https://blog.checkpoint.com/partners/check-point-expands-strategic-collaboration-with-aws-to-accelerate-ai-and-cloud-security-capabilities/

Product Launch | Cloudflare | AI Data Delivery | 2026-10-19

Cloudflare Introduces Clairic Extraction Model on Workers AI

Cloudflare previewed Clairic on Workers AI, a 'System One' extraction model that pulls typed values from unstructured input in a single forward pass without generating output tokens, at about $0.10 per million input tokens. It supports a 65,536-token context window and returns a confidence score per value; Cloudflare reported roughly 49% lower cost than a full LLM pipeline in a claims-processing benchmark. This strengthens Cloudflare's edge inference offer against F5 AI Data Delivery.

Source: https://blog.cloudflare.com/clairic-extraction-model/

Product Launch AWS AI Data Delivery 2026-10-19

Grok 4.7 Now Available on Amazon Bedrock in AWS GovCloud (US)

AWS made xAI's Grok 4.7 available on Amazon Bedrock in AWS GovCloud (US) for coding, agentic tasks and knowledge work, citing improvements over Grok 4.6 in mixed documents, repository-scale coding and browser-use agents. Customers access it through the Bedrock console or APIs. More Bedrock models for public sector expands the AI inference traffic F5 AI Gateway and AI Guardrails can secure and route in government deployments.

Source: https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/10/amazon-bedrock-grok-4-7-govcloud/

Product Launch AWS AI Data Delivery 2026-10-19

Amazon's TorchNeuron Runs PyTorch on AWS Trainium with Zero Rewrites

Amazon introduced TorchNeuron, which runs existing PyTorch code natively on AWS Trainium with one configuration change, with open-sourcing planned at PyTorch Conference North America on October 20. It supports PyTorch's standard hardware registration and TorchTitan for distributed training; early adopters include Cartesia and the Lieber Institute. Easier Trainium adoption could pull AI infrastructure toward AWS silicon, which F5 should watch as it builds AI data delivery for NVIDIA-centric GPU environments.

Source: https://www.aboutamazon.com/news/innovation-at-amazon/torchneuron-pytorch-aws-trainium-chips-ai

Partnership Akamai Platforms 2026-10-19

Akamai and Cyera Detail Data-Aware Microsegmentation for AI Pipelines via Guardicore

Akamai described an integration that brings Cyera's data discovery and classification labels (PII/PHI, GDPR/HIPAA) into Akamai Guardicore Segmentation as asset labels, which then drive microsegmentation rules limiting lateral movement. Akamai combines data sensitivity with exposure analysis, blast radius and reachability, to rank remediation across AI data stores, training repositories and agents. Akamai is turning its security platform into a data-centric zero trust offer for AI infrastructure.

Source: https://www.akamai.com/blog/security/secure-sensitive-data-cyera-akamai-guardicore-segmentation

Product Launch Akamai Application Security 2026-10-19

Akamai Updates Web Security Analytics with Better Search and a Collapsible AI Assistant

Akamai's Web Security Analytics changelog adds Case IDs and API Operation Names to the Events panel and makes them searchable, and the AI Assistant button now starts collapsed. Fixes include an accurate 'Last 30 Days' range and standard X-Request-Id correlation headers for distributed tracing. Akamai is steadily adding AI assistance and API-level visibility to its WAAP analytics, competing with F5's security analytics experience.

Source: https://techdocs.akamai.com/security-ctr/changelog/oct-19-2026-improvements-to-web-security-analytics

Product Launch | Fastly | Application Security | 2026-10-19

Fastly Adds Network Protect L3/L4 DDoS Plan to Its Pricing Page

PricingSaaS reports Fastly added Network Protect to its public pricing page as a contact-sales plan. Network Protect, first described in an October 14 blog, is always-on network-layer DDoS defense without scrubbing centers or hardware, using BGP routing, customer-defined firewall rules and GRE tunnels to return clean traffic on a network Fastly says has 622 Tbps of capacity. Fastly is now packaging inline volumetric DDoS protection against F5's DDoS offerings.

Source: https://pricingsaas.com/companies/fastly/diffs/2026W43

Partnership | HPE / Juniper Networks | Platforms | 2026-10-19

HPE and Miami HEAT Deploy an AI-Native Self-Driving Network at Kaseya Center

HPE and the Miami HEAT announced a network modernization at Kaseya Center using HPE Aruba Wi-Fi 7 access points, campus gateways and Juniper switching, managed by HPE's AI-native self-driving network for automatic optimization and troubleshooting. The phased rollout includes monitoring at five live events ahead of the 2026-27 NBA season, with AT&T and CSPi as partners. HPE is using the combined Aruba and Juniper portfolio to win AI-driven campus networking deals.

Source: https://www.hpe.com/us/en/newsroom/press-release/2026/10/hpe-and-miami-heat-transform-kaseya-center-fan-experience-with-ai-native-wireless-connectivity-powered-by-an-hpe-self-driving-network.html

Product Launch | Barracuda Networks | AI Security | 2026-10-19

Barracuda Launches AI Data Security in Japan

Barracuda Japan announced Barracuda AI Data Security, an AI security and governance solution for resource-constrained organizations built on BarracudaONE and the BarracudaIQ engine, covering 1,300+ AI tools. It blocks sensitive data from reaching generative AI, detects OWASP LLM Top 10 threats such as prompt injection and jailbreaks, and adds audit trails and per-team policies, included with SecureEdge Premium Access at no extra cost. Barracuda is bringing AI governance to mid-market and MSP buyers that F5 AI Guardrails also targets.

Source: https://www.barracuda.co.jp/news/2026/barracuda-ai-data-security-ai-governance/